

MEDILAB

Patient Test Preparation & Specimen Collection Guide

Knowledge Base Category: Preparation

Document Type	Customer-facing process / policy guidance
Intended Use	RAG knowledge retrieval and website reference
Version	1.0 - Assessment Dataset
Clinical Boundary	Operational information only; not clinical advice

Customer-facing instructions for preparing for laboratory testing and providing common specimen types safely and consistently.

Quick Reference

Use this document for	Do not use this document for
Stable customer-service process, policy, preparation, FAQ, and operational guidance.	Live prices, slot availability, booking status, patient-specific clinical interpretation, diagnosis, or medication advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This guide explains the standard preparation steps patients should follow before laboratory testing at MediLab. It is designed for routine customer-service use and covers fasting, hydration, appointment readiness, common self-collected specimens, and what to do when preparation instructions were not followed.

Test-specific instructions always take priority over this general guide. If the order, test catalog, or a qualified healthcare professional provides different preparation instructions, follow those instructions. Customer-service staff should not advise a patient to stop, start, or change prescription medicines, supplements, or treatment.

2. Before the Appointment

Patients should review the test name, location, visit type, and preparation instructions before the day of collection. For branch visits, bring the booking confirmation or reference if available and a valid form of identification. If a clinician or external facility provided a laboratory request, bring it when required by the booking.

Arrive at the booked time and allow extra time for check-in, identity verification, and order confirmation. Tell the collection staff before specimen collection if the preparation instructions were not followed, if the patient is unsure which tests were ordered, or if the patient has difficulty with blood collection or has previously fainted during venipuncture.

3. Fasting and Hydration

Not every blood test requires fasting. Fasting should only be followed when the test-specific preparation instruction says it is required. Unless a test-specific instruction says otherwise, fasting means no food or caloric drinks during the fasting window; plain water is allowed and encouraged because good hydration can make collection easier.

During a fasting period, avoid coffee, tea, milk, juice, soft drinks, energy drinks, chewing gum, smoking, and nicotine products unless the ordering clinician has given different instructions. Patients should not extend a fasting period beyond the specified window simply to be 'more accurate'.

If a patient accidentally eats or drinks something other than water during a required fasting window, the patient should tell MediLab staff before collection. The collection team will determine whether the test can proceed, should be documented as non-fasting, or should be rescheduled according to the test-specific requirement.

4. Medicines, Vitamins, and Supplements

MediLab customer-service staff do not instruct patients to stop medicines or supplements. Patients should continue medicines as directed unless the ordering clinician or the test-specific preparation instruction says otherwise.

Some tests may be affected by medicines, vitamins, herbal products, or supplements. When a preparation note refers to medication timing, the patient should confirm the instruction with the ordering clinician or qualified healthcare professional. If the patient is unsure, collect the question and escalate it rather than guessing.

5. Timing-Sensitive and Special-Preparation Tests

Some laboratory tests are sensitive to the time of day, recent meals, physical activity, or a defined collection interval. Where a timed collection is required, the booking and collection should follow the test-specific instruction. Customer service should not invent a timing requirement that is not present in the trusted test record or knowledge base.

For tests requiring a timed urine collection or another special specimen, provide the approved written instructions before collection begins. If the patient cannot follow the required timing, container, or storage instructions, the collection may need to restart to protect specimen quality.

6. Urine Specimens

For routine urine testing, the patient should use the container supplied or approved by MediLab and follow the collection instruction provided with the test. The container should not be reused for food, drink, medicines, or household products.

Avoid touching the inside of the container or lid. Close the container securely after collection. If the sample is spilled, contaminated, or collected in the wrong container, contact MediLab for a replacement rather than transferring the specimen between containers.

7. Stool and Other Self-Collected Specimens

For stool, saliva, swab, or other self-collected specimens, follow the kit instructions supplied with the order. The correct container, label, collection method, storage condition, and delivery time may vary by test.

If the patient is unsure whether the specimen is acceptable, do not advise them to 'try anyway.' The safer customer-service response is to verify the specific test instruction or ask the laboratory team before the specimen is accepted.

8. Identification and Labeling

At collection, MediLab verifies the patient using at least two identifying details appropriate to the service workflow, such as full name and date of birth or another unique identifier. Specimen labels must match the verified patient and order information.

A specimen with missing, conflicting, or unreliable identification may require recollection. Staff must not relabel a specimen using assumptions or information that cannot be verified.

9. If Preparation Was Not Followed

The patient should disclose the issue before collection whenever possible. Examples include eating during a required fast, taking a supplement against a documented preparation instruction, collecting outside a required time window, or using the wrong container.

MediLab may proceed, document the deviation, or request a new collection depending on the test requirement. Customer service should explain the operational next step, but should not clinically interpret how the deviation might change the test result.

10. When Customer Service Must Escalate

Escalate preparation questions when the answer would require changing a medicine, deciding whether a medically necessary test should be performed, interpreting symptoms, deciding whether an abnormal result is expected, or choosing a test based on symptoms.

MediLab provides preparation and process information only. Clinical decisions belong to a qualified healthcare professional.

Document Control Notes

- This is a fictional MediLab assessment document designed to resemble real diagnostic-laboratory customer-service documentation.
- If a live structured record conflicts with this document, the structured record controls for price, availability, booking, status, and test-specific catalog values.
- If a future policy changes, update the KnowledgeDocument version and reindex the RAG corpus so stale chunks are removed.
- Customer service must not use this document to diagnose, clinically interpret results, prescribe medication, or recommend medically necessary tests from symptoms.